Anirudhya thanked his IB friend and left for office. Around eight in the evening, Bina from *India Today*'s reception called Anirudhya at his desk, saying Chandrasekharan was on the line, and connected the two.

Chandrasekharan told *India Today* that while going through the photographs of the blast site published across newspapers, the forensics team had noticed a camera among the heaps of bodies. His instant reaction was that the pictures taken by the camera could be of immense value. He had asked his team why the camera had not been acquired. Chandrasekharan had further checked with his photographer to bring in the video footage of the morning when he and his team were collecting evidence at the blast site. A replay of the video did not show any camera at the spot. Someone must have picked it up at the time of clearing the bodies, Chandrasekharan told his team, adding it be retrieved at the earliest.

Chandrasekharan did not waste even a minute. He headed for Kanchipuram Hospital. But nobody could give him any information on the camera at the morgue. There he saw two unidentified, dismembered bodies —one male and one female—brought in from the blast site. He suspected something very serious. While examining the corpses at the morgue, he learnt that one of them was a freelance photographer. He tried to join the dots—camera seen in the heaps of bodies and a dead photographer. It was highly likely that he had captured the last moments of Rajiv Gandhi's assassination. Further inquiry by his team revealed the name of the photographer as Haribabu; he had been seen clicking photographs of Rajiv Gandhi upon his arrival in Sriperumbudur.

Chandrasekharan was determined to get hold of Haribabu's camera. He went back to the blast site the following morning. But nobody knew anything about the camera. He went back to his laboratory and found a young policeman from the CID waiting for him. The young policeman was a police photographer who had collected the camera at the instruction of the IG (CID) R.K. Raghavan. The senior cop had thought on the same lines as the senior forensics man. The police photographer told Chandrasekharan that he could not develop the film roll inside the 'Chinon' camera retrieved from the crime scene due to a bandh observed in the city following the